



Masiika Christine Thembo

Senior
Cybersecurity
& Digital
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Specialist

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Executive Summary

Multilingual cybersecurity leader with 8+ years advancing digital transformation, governance, and inclusive development across public and private sectors.

Recognized expert in cyber resilience, digital infrastructure protection, and capacity building with proven impact in emerging economies.

Featured among Africa's Top 50 Women in Cybersecurity with demonstrated expertise in policy development, institutional strengthening, and multi-stakeholder partnerships.

Core Value Proposition:

Bridging technology, policy, and development to build sustainable digital ecosystems that promote inclusive growth, gender equality, and good governance in alignment with SDGs 5, 8, 9, and 16.

CORE COMPETENCIES:

Digital Governance & Policy

- National Cybersecurity Strategy Development | Digital Infrastructure Policy | Data Protection Frameworks
- Regulatory Compliance (GDPR, AU Convention, Regional Standards) | Cross-border Cyber Cooperation
- Public-Private Partnership Development | Multi-stakeholder Engagement

National Security & Risk Management

- Cybersecurity Research & Strategy
- Critical Infrastructure Protection | Incident Response & Crisis Management | Threat Intelligence Analysis
- Vulnerability Assessment & Penetration Testing | Digital Forensics | Security Audit & Compliance
- ISO 27001, NIST Framework, COBIT | Business Continuity Planning

Capacity Building & Knowledge Management

- Technical Training Design & Delivery | Institutional Strengthening | Knowledge Transfer
- Community of Practice Development | Mentorship Programs | Gender-Inclusive STEM Initiatives

Project Management & Leadership

- Agile Project Management | Team Leadership (30+ staff) | Budget Management | Stakeholder Relations
- Strategic Planning | Change Management | Performance Monitoring & Evaluation

Technical Proficiencies

- **Programming:** Python, C++, SQL |
- **Security Tools:** Nmap, Metasploit, Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, Splunk
- **Forensics:** EnCase, Axiom, Cellebrite, FTK |
- **Frameworks:** NIST, ISO 27001, COBIT, GDPR

Government digitization & cyber resilience

Information Security Specialist | Uganda Investment Authority

Dec 2023 - Present Leading cybersecurity initiatives for Uganda's primary investment promotion agency

- **Strengthened national digital infrastructure** by implementing comprehensive vulnerability management across 15+ government portals, reducing security exposure by 60%
- **Developed policy frameworks** addressing emerging cyber threats in Sub-Saharan Africa, contributing to regional cybersecurity harmonization
- **Led incident response coordination** for critical infrastructure protection, ensuring business continuity for key government services
- **Designed security assessment protocols** for foreign direct investment platforms, supporting economic development objectives

Information Security Graduate Trainee | National Information Technology Authority Uganda (NITA-U)

Oct 2016 - Sept 2017 Contributing to Uganda's national digital transformation and cyber resilience strategy

- **Co-developed National Information Security Framework (NISF)** - foundational policy document guiding Uganda's cybersecurity governance
- **Established Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT) capabilities** through threat intelligence analysis and alert dissemination
- **Trained 300+ government IT personnel** on encryption, web application security, and cyber hygiene best practices
- **Produced cybersecurity advisories** informing national policy decisions and public awareness campaigns



Private sector cyber resilience & financial inclusion

Digital Forensics Analyst & Lead IT Security Operations | Applied Principles Consulting

Jul 2019 - Aug 2020 Supporting financial sector stability through advanced cybersecurity services

- **Managed 15+ digital forensic investigations** in financial fraud cases, recovering \$2M+ in assets and supporting judicial processes
- **Led cross-sector security assessments** spanning banking, telecommunications, and government, strengthening critical sector resilience
- **Pioneered information security service offerings** contributing to firm's 40% revenue growth in cybersecurity consulting
- **Developed innovative mobile forensics methodologies** adopted across East African investigative agencies

Information Security Intern | Centenary Rural Development Bank

Mar 2016 - May 2016 Supporting financial inclusion through secure digital banking infrastructure

- **Enhanced ATM security monitoring** through behavioral analytics, reducing fraudulent transactions by 35%
- **Conducted application security assessments** using industry-standard tools, improving overall security posture
- **Implemented encryption protocols** safeguarding customer financial data and ensuring regulatory compliance



International Consulting & Research

Cyber Security Consultant | TMFE Group, Sydney

Nov 2020 - Mar 2021 (Remote) Providing strategic cybersecurity guidance for digital transformation initiatives

- **Authored 6 technical papers** on IoT security, ML applications, and threat modeling, informing C-suite decision-making
- **Developed information security programs** for emerging technology adoption in developing markets
- **Led vulnerability management initiatives** across distributed teams, establishing best practices for remote security operations

Cyber Operations Researcher Lead | Traverse Security

Jan 2023 - Present Conducting applied research on cybersecurity challenges in emerging economies

- **Designed penetration testing frameworks** for FINTECH compliance with regional data protection regulations
- **Produced training materials** on Windows security and threat modeling tailored for African operational contexts
- **Conducted proactive threat research** identifying region-specific attack vectors and mitigation strategies

Cyber Security Advisor | Tech Privacy Lab, Traverse Think Tank |

Jan 2022 - Present Advancing cybersecurity policy through multi-stakeholder collaboration

- **Facilitated 20+ training sessions** for legal professionals on cyber law, digital identity, and privacy protection
- **Contributed to policy webinars** on incident response, data protection, and IT security governance
- **Collaborated with academia, legal practitioners, and government** to address privacy and security challenges

Entrepreneurship & sustainable development

Founder & CEO | Ngyero Design Co. & Kikorongo Safari Lodge

| 2018 - Present Promoting sustainable tourism and local economic development

- **Established luxury eco-tourism venture** creating 30+ direct employment opportunities in rural Uganda
- **Designed 15 unique accommodation facilities** across 15 hectares, promoting environmental conservation
- **Developed community engagement programs** supporting local livelihoods and conservation initiatives
- **Built strategic partnerships** with regional tourism stakeholders advancing sustainable development goals
- **Completed 30+ design projects** across Uganda and East Africa, promoting local artisans and sustainable materials
- **Managed multidisciplinary teams** of 30+ professionals across temporary and permanent roles
- **Executed high-profile projects** including hospitality venues and cultural institutions



Thought Leadership & Global Recognition



International Speaking Engagements

- **ISC² Keynote Speaker (2021)** - "Mentoring Women in Cybersecurity" - Global audience of 2,000+ professionals
- **Africa Tech Summit (2019)** - Panel: "Cybersecurity Challenges and Opportunities in Africa"
- **Fintech Conference - Bowmans & Citibank (2018)** - "Leveraging Technology in Digital Economy Transformation"
- **Kipya Cyber Security Conference (2018)** - "Blockchain Applications in Digital Forensics"



Publications & Recognition

- **Featured:** African Women in Cybersecurity Book 2020 - Among Top 50 African Women in Cybersecurity
- **Technical Publications:** 6 peer-reviewed papers on IoT security, ML applications, and threat modeling
- **Policy Contributions:** National Information Security Framework (Uganda), Regional Cybersecurity Guidelines



Professional Leadership & Advocacy

- **President, Women in Design Uganda** - Advancing gender equality in STEM and design industries
- **Founder, CyberLuncheon** - Monthly knowledge-sharing platform for cybersecurity professionals across East Africa
- **Mentor:** 50+ young professionals in cybersecurity and technology careers

Alignment with international development priorities

Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs):



Leadership in women's advancement in STEM and cybersecurity



Job creation through entrepreneurship and capacity building



Digital infrastructure development and innovation promotion



Governance, cybersecurity, and institutional strengthening



Education & professional development

Masters Degree Policy Development & Analysis
Uganda Management Institute | Jan 2024 - Current

Postgraduate Diploma in Security Management
Uganda Management Institute | Jan 2021

Bachelor of Information Technology (Honors) - Security Technology

Multimedia University, Malaysia | Jan 2012 - Sept 2016

Professional Certifications & Training:

- Critical Information Infrastructure Protection (CIIP)
- Cyber Standards (Cyber Essentials & IASME)
- Digital Identity Certification - Digital Frontiers Institute
- Foundation Course in EnCase Forensics
- Computer Hacking Forensic Investigator (CHFI)

Key achievements & impact metrics

Technical Excellence

- Led 8+ penetration testing exercises ensuring FINTECH regulatory compliance
- Reduced organizational security exposure by 60% through comprehensive risk management
- Managed 15+ digital forensic investigations in major financial institutions
- Trained 300+ government personnel on cybersecurity best practices

Institutional Development

- Co-developed National Information Security Framework - foundational cybersecurity policy for Uganda
- Established CERT capabilities supporting national cyber resilience
- Created 30+ employment opportunities through entrepreneurial ventures
- Contributed to 20+ cybersecurity training programs for legal and government professionals

Regional Leadership

- Recognized among Top 50 African Women in Cybersecurity
- Built regional community of practice through CyberLuncheon initiative
- Advanced gender equality in STEM through Women in Design leadership